

STATE OF READINESS Gen. Munir at an army outpost at the Line of Control, December 2022

ACADEMIC RECORD

In the army, Munir further pursued education, acquiring an MPhil in public policy and strategic security management from the National Defence University (NDU) in Islamabad. He also attended professional courses at Japan's Fuji School and Malaysia's Armed Forces Staff College

KEY COMMAND AND STAFF POSTS

↘ In 2015, as a brigadier, he was appointed Force Commander Northern Areas, commanding troops in Gilgit-Baltistan in PoK, where he impressed Qamar Javed Bajwa, his X Corps commander

↘ In 2017, when Bajwa was army chief, he made Munir Director-General of Military Intelligence and, a year later, Director General, ISI, Pakistan's external spy agency

↘ In 2019, he fell out with PM Imran Khan and was shunted out as ISI chief because he is said to have presented Imran with intelligence on corruption involving his wife, Bushra Bibi

↘ He was then posted to command XXX Corps in Gujranwala for two years. In 2021, Munir was made the Quartermaster General at army headquarters

CONTROVERSY OVER HIS APPOINTMENT AS CHIEF

When Bajwa was to retire in November 2022, Munir was the seniormost serving general. But Imran Khan, who had resigned as prime minister after Bajwa had engineered his ouster through a parliamentary no-confidence motion, protested Munir's selection. Critically, the Sharif brothers—Shehbaz, as prime minister, and Nawaz Sharif, his mentor—backed Munir and President Asif Alvi, who owed loyalty to Imran, was forced to endorse Munir's appointment as army chief

EXTENSION OF TENURE

Munir was to retire in November 2025 after completing three years in the saddle. But in November 2024, he got Pakistan's parliament to pass a bill extending the tenure of all service chiefs from 3 years to 5 years, removing the upper age limit for a four-star chief. Munir's current tenure will now end in 2027, after which he is still eligible for reappointment

PERSONAL TRAITS

A fitness freak and an avid reader of strategic books, Munir is said to have a keen sense of duty, discipline and deep religious faith. He is considered to be pragmatic but is ever willing to take on his opponents

CIRCLE



Khawaja Asif
Defence Minister



Mohsin Naqvi
Interior Minister



Gen. Sahir Shamshad Mirza
Chairman of Joint Chiefs of Staff Committee



Lt Gen. Asim Malik
DG, ISI



Air Chief Marshal Zaheer Ahmed Baber Sidhu
Air Chief



Admiral Naveed Ashraf
Naval Chief

(XI Corps), **Rahat Naseem Ahmed Khan** (XII Corps), **Syed Imdad Hussain Shah** (XXX Corps), **Nauman Zakaria** (I Corps), **Ahmad Sharif Chaudhry**, DG ISPR, **Muhammad Shahbaz Khan**, Commander, Army Strategic Forces Command, **Syed Aamer Raza** , Chief of General Staff, GHQ, **Sarfaraz Ahmed**, National Coordinator, SIFC